

Testing Plan Summary / สรุปแผนการทดสอบสำหรับลูกค้า

ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer Trigger / Cross-Layer Thin-Reclaimed RCA

Windows Server 2022, InfoScale for Windows, VMware, HPE Alletra 9060

Executive Summary / สรุปสำหรับผู้บริหาร

English

The customer observed a hang/delay of approximately 20 minutes after deleting a large SQL backup file of about 1.2 TB in a Windows Server 2022 VM using Veritas / InfoScale for Windows with HPE Alletra 9060 storage.

The current field observation is that the issue no longer occurs when **DisableDeleteNotify=1**. However, because the customer requires **DisableDeleteNotify=0**, the purpose of this plan is to validate whether **ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim** is the trigger for delayed **UNMAP(TRIM)** activity and to determine where the hang/delay occurs across the infrastructure stack.

The main customer-facing approach is:

- Reproduce the issue in a baseline condition
- Isolate whether disabling ScheduledDefrag changes the behavior
- Validate the current workaround as a comparison point
- Collect evidence across Windows, Veritas, VMware, and HPE Alletra 9060 so that the next RCA action can focus on the correct layer

ลูกค้าพบอาการ hang/delay ประมาณ 20 นาที หลังลบไฟล์ SQL backup ขนาดประมาณ 1.2 TB ภายใน VM ที่เป็น Windows Server 2022 ใช้งานร่วมกับ Veritas / InfoScale for Windows และ HPE Alletra 9060 storage

จาก field observation ปัจจุบัน พบว่าอาการดังกล่าวไม่เกิดเมื่อกำหนด **DisableDeleteNotify=1** แต่เนื่องจากลูกค้าต้องการใช้งานด้วย **DisableDeleteNotify=0** แผนนี้จึงมีเป้าหมายเพื่อพิสูจน์ว่า **ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim** เป็น trigger ของ delayed **UNMAP(TRIM)** หรือไม่ และเพื่อระบุว่าการ hang/delay เกิดที่ layer ใดใน infrastructure stack

แนวทางหลักที่ใช้ในการสื่อสารกับลูกค้าคือ:

- ทำ baseline เพื่อ reproduce อาการ
- isolate ว่าการปิด ScheduledDefrag เปลี่ยนพฤติกรรมหรือไม่
- validate workaround ปัจจุบันในฐานะ comparison point
- เก็บหลักฐานจาก Windows, Veritas, VMware และ HPE Alletra 9060 เพื่อให้ next RCA action ลงลึกใน layer ที่ถูกต้อง

02 Purpose and Objectives / วัตถุประสงค์และเป้าหมาย

English

This testing plan is designed to validate whether **Windows ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim** is the trigger for delayed **UNMAP(TRIM)** activity after large SQL backup file deletion, and to identify where the observed hang/delay occurs across the infrastructure stack.

The main objectives are:

- Validate whether **ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim** triggers UNMAP(TRIM) activity following large file deletion
- Isolate where the observed hang/delay occurs or propagates across the stack:

```
Windows Server 2022 guest OS
Veritas / InfoScale for Windows / vxio
VMware virtual disk / datastore
HPE Alletra 9060 backend storage
```

- Produce a structured evidence set that supports the next RCA action on the correct layer
- Confirm whether the current workaround changes the observed behavior, while keeping **DisableDeleteNotify=0** as the main customer requirement for trigger isolation

แผนการทดสอบนี้มีวัตถุประสงค์เพื่อพิสูจน์ว่า **Windows ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim** เป็น trigger ของ delayed **UNMAP(TRIM)** หลังลบไฟล์ SQL backup ขนาดใหญ่หรือไม่ และเพื่อหาว่าอาการ hang/delay เกิดที่ layer ใดใน infrastructure stack

เป้าหมายหลักของแผนมีดังนี้:

- พิสูจน์ว่า **ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim** เป็น trigger ของ UNMAP(TRIM) หลังการลบไฟล์ขนาดใหญ่หรือไม่
- แยกให้ได้ว่าอาการ hang/delay เกิดขึ้นหรือ propagate ที่ layer ใด:

```
Windows Server 2022 guest OS
Veritas / InfoScale for Windows / vxio
VMware virtual disk / datastore
HPE Alletra 9060 backend storage
```

- สร้างชุดหลักฐานที่ช่วยชี้ว่า next RCA action ควรลงลึกที่ layer ใด
- ยืนยันว่า workaround ปัจจุบันมีผลต่อพฤติกรรมที่พบอย่างไร โดยยังคง **DisableDeleteNotify=0** เป็น customer requirement หลักสำหรับการ isolate trigger

03 Current Working Hypothesis / สมมติฐานการทดสอบปัจจุบัน

English

The current working hypothesis is that the customer-visible hang/delay may be associated with **Storage Optimizer / ReTrim-driven UNMAP activity** after large file deletion, rather than with the delete action alone.

This plan is intentionally designed to validate or disprove that hypothesis with cross-layer evidence.

สมมติฐานการทดสอบปัจจุบันคือ อาการ hang/delay ที่ลูกค้าพบอาจสัมพันธ์กับ **Storage Optimizer / ReTrim-driven UNMAP activity** หลังลบไฟล์ขนาดใหญ่ มากกว่าจะเกิดจากคำสั่งลบไฟล์เพียงอย่างเดียว ดังนั้นแผนนี้จึงถูกออกแบบมาเพื่อพิสูจน์หรือหักล้างสมมติฐานดังกล่าวด้วยหลักฐานจากหลาย layer

04 Scope / ขอบเขต

In Scope

Windows Server 2022
Veritas / InfoScale for Windows
Windows ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim
Windows disk latency / queue length
Defrag Operational Event Log
VMware VM disk and datastore latency
HPE Alletra 9060 VLUN / VV / port latency
Large SQL backup deletion workflow

Out of Scope

Permanent production tuning
Firmware upgrade
SQL Server performance tuning
Source code analysis
Long-term monitoring setup

05 Tools Used / เครื่องมือที่ใช้

Layer	Tool / Method	Purpose
Windows Server 2022	PowerShell collectors	Timeline, disk counters, defrag.exe, fsutil state
Windows Performance	PerfMon BLG / logman	Native Windows performance evidence
Windows Events	Event Viewer / Get-WinEvent	Defrag, System, Disk, StorPort, MPIO, PVSCSI events
Veritas / InfoScale	vxprint, vxstat, vxdisk, vxdmpadm, hastatus	VxVM/DMP/path/volume state
VMware	VMware PowerCLI / Get-Stat	VM disk and datastore latency
HPE Alletra 9060	SSH CLI: statvln , srstatvln , statvv , statport	Backend storage latency and service stats

Mandatory collection

VMware and HPE Alletra 9060 are **mandatory** because Objective 2 is to identify where the hang/delay occurs.

Without VMware latency, datastore/virtual layer cannot be confirmed.
Without HPE Alletra 9060 latency, backend storage layer cannot be confirmed.

06 Prerequisites / สิ่งที่ต้องเตรียมก่อนวันทดสอบ

Customer preparation required

The following items should be prepared before the test window starts:

Target SQL backup file for deletion
Confirmed file recreation/copy-back method for each next scenario
Windows admin access
VMware PowerCLI access
HPE Alletra 9060 management / SSH access
Agreed test window long enough for A/B/C execution

Test file requirement / ข้อกำหนดของไฟล์ทดสอบ

Item	Requirement
File type	Large SQL backup file, for example .bak
File size	Approximately 1.2 TB or equivalent agreed test size
File path	Full path must be confirmed before test start
Volume	Drive letter / target volume must be confirmed
Safety	Customer must confirm the file can be deleted safely
Reuse across scenarios	Same file or an equivalent file should be used for A/B/C consistency
Recreate plan	File must be recreated or copied back before the next scenario
Owner	Customer/team owner should be identified for file preparation and restore

Why this prerequisite matters / เหตุผลที่ต้องเตรียมล่วงหน้า

Each scenario consumes the target file by deleting it.
Without a confirmed recreate/copy-back plan, Scenario B and Scenario C cannot be executed consistently.

If the file size or location differs between scenarios, the comparison value of the test results is reduced.

07 Main Test Scenarios / Scenario หลักของการทดสอบ

Important note:

The main customer test plan uses Scenario A/B/C only.
Manual Optimize-Volume / ReTrim is NOT part of the main A/B/C execution flow.
If extra confirmation is needed, use Appendix A as an optional test after the main scenarios are completed.

Scenario A — Reproduce / Baseline

Purpose:

Confirm issue can be reproduced under TRIM-enabled behavior.

Configuration:

Setting	Value
DisableDeleteNotify	0
ScheduledDefrag	Enabled / current production behavior
VMware collection	Mandatory
HPE Alletra 9060 collection	Mandatory

Expected:

If hang/delay occurs, this is the known-bad baseline evidence set.

Scenario B — Trigger Isolation: ScheduledDefrag Disabled

Purpose:

Determine whether ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim is the trigger.

Configuration:

Setting	Value
DisableDeleteNotify	0
ScheduledDefrag	Disabled
defrag.exe	Not running before deletion
VMware collection	Mandatory
HPE Alletra 9060 collection	Mandatory

Expected:

If no hang/slowness occurs for 60+ minutes after deletion, ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim is strongly supported as the trigger.

Scenario C — Mitigation Validation / Known-Good Control

Purpose:

Validate customer mitigation effectiveness.

Configuration:

Setting	Value
DisableDeleteNotify	1
ScheduledDefrag	Disabled
defrag.exe	Not running before deletion
VMware collection	Mandatory
HPE Alletra 9060 collection	Mandatory

Expected:

No hang/slowness should occur.
This confirms mitigation effectiveness but does not by itself prove ScheduledDefrag is the only trigger.

08 Estimated Duration / เวลาที่ใช้โดยประมาณ

Per Scenario

Phase	Activity	Estimated Time
1	Configure scenario state	5 mins
2	Baseline Windows / Veritas snapshot	10 mins
3	Start Windows / VMware / HPE collectors	10-15 mins
4	Mark before delete + delete file + mark after delete	5-10 mins
5	Observation window	60 mins minimum
6	Stop collectors and export evidence	10-15 mins
7	Quick evidence sanity check	10 mins

Estimated per scenario:

~1.5 to 2 hours

Full A/B/C run

~4.5 to 6 hours total

Note:

Each scenario requires a large SQL backup file to exist before deletion. If the same file is used, it must be recreated/copied again before the next scenario. Customer preparation time for recreating/copying the file should be included in the test schedule.

09 Step-by-Step Runbook / ขั้นตอนการทำงาน

The detailed operator runbook is in:

02-Step-by-Step-Operator-Runbook-TH-EN.md

Important structure:

Steps 1-3 = Common preparation
Steps 4-16 = Standard execution block for ONE scenario

Repeat Steps 4–16 for Scenario A, Scenario B, and Scenario C
Use a separate OutputDir for each scenario

Recommended OutputDir:

Scenario A: C:\Temp\TrimTest-A-Baseline
Scenario B: C:\Temp\TrimTest-B-DefragDisabled
Scenario C: C:\Temp\TrimTest-C-Mitigation

10 Expected Results / ผลที่คาดหวัง

Scenario	Expected Result	Meaning
A	Issue reproduces	Baseline/known-bad confirmed
B	No hang/slowness	ScheduledDefrag/ReTrim likely trigger
B	hang/slowness still occurs	Trigger may not be ScheduledDefrag alone; deeper path/RCA needed
C	No hang/slowness	Mitigation effective
C	hang/slowness still occurs	Issue not fully dependent on TRIM/Optimizer path

11 Interpretation Logic / วิเคราะห์ผลทดสอบ

Use the matrix below during result review. Mark **Yes** or **No** based on the evidence collected in each scenario.

ใช้ตารางด้านล่างระหว่างการ review ผลทดสอบ โดยทำเครื่องหมาย **Yes** หรือ **No** ตามหลักฐานที่เก็บได้ในแต่ละ scenario

Area	Checkpoint / Expected Evidence	Yes	No	Meaning if Yes
Trigger	Scenario A: issue is reproduced under baseline condition	☐	☐	Baseline issue confirmed
Trigger	Scenario B: with DisableDeleteNotify=0 and ScheduledDefrag = disabled, issue is not reproduced	☐	☐	ScheduledDefrag / Storage Optimizer / ReTrim is likely trigger
Trigger	Scenario C: with DisableDeleteNotify=1 and ScheduledDefrag = disabled, issue is not reproduced	☐	☐	Workaround behavior confirmed

Area	Checkpoint / Expected Evidence	Yes	No	Meaning if Yes
Layer	Windows evidence shows latency spike at issue time	☐	☐	Windows / filesystem / Veritas layer involved
Layer	VMware evidence shows latency spike at issue time	☐	☐	VMware layer involved
Layer	HPE Alletra 9060 evidence shows latency spike at issue time	☐	☐	Backend storage / reclaim layer involved
Layer	Windows, VMware, and HPE Alletra 9060 show spikes at the same time	☐	☐	Backend propagation or shared-path stall is possible
Optimizer path	Optimizer activity is still observed while ScheduledDefrag = disabled	☐	☐	Another optimizer trigger may exist; check defrag.exe , Defrag Operational events, Optimize-Volume , policy, third-party tools, or manual trigger

12 Deliverables / หลักฐานที่ต้องส่งมอบ

For each scenario, deliver a separate evidence folder.

Scenario A: C:\Temp\TrimTest-A-Baseline
 Scenario B: C:\Temp\TrimTest-B-DefragDisabled
 Scenario C: C:\Temp\TrimTest-C-Mitigation

Each evidence folder should include:

Windows

```
disk_latency_counters.csv
disk_latency_perfmon.blg
defrag_process_monitor.csv
defrag_event_monitor.csv
fsutil_trim_status.csv
timeline_markers.csv
environment_snapshot.txt
summary_after_stop.txt
windows-eventlogs-*.zip
storage-snapshot-*.zip
```

Veritas / InfoScale

```
veritas-windows-*.zip
```

VMware

```
vmware-vm-disk-latency.csv  
vmware-datastore-latency.csv
```

HPE Alletra 9060

```
3par-latency-*.log  
3par-commands-*.txt
```

Final customer summary

```
Scenario comparison table  
Trigger conclusion  
Most likely hang/delay layer  
Recommended next action
```

Appendix A - Optional Manual Optimize-Volume / ReTrim Confirmation Test

Purpose:

```
Use only if the customer wants additional confirmation after Scenario  
A/B/C.  
This optional test helps determine whether a manually initiated  
optimizer/retrim pass can reproduce the same delay pattern.
```

Key positioning:

```
This is not part of the main customer A/B/C test flow.  
This appendix is only for additional confirmation when the customer  
requests deeper validation.
```

Suggested setup:

Setting	Value
DisableDeleteNotify	0
ScheduledDefrag	Disabled
Manual Optimize-Volume	Run only after file deletion and evidence collectors are already running
OutputDir	Separate optional folder, for example C:\Temp\TrimTest-D-ManualRetrim

Interpretation:

If the environment stays stable after deletion but slows/hangs only after manual Optimize-Volume/ReTrim, that would further support the hypothesis that the optimizer-driven reclaim path is the trigger.

Appendix B - Tuning Considerations (Not Part of Main Test Execution)

The following items are intentionally excluded from the main A/B/C scenarios and should be discussed only after the trigger and affected layer are validated:

```
vol_tp_reclaim_limit  
vol_tp_reclaim_idle_delay
```

Reason:

Tuning may change behavior, pacing, or visibility of the issue. Applying tuning before trigger isolation would weaken the evidentiary value of the RCA test.